

flood relief, improve governance, and more. The advantage of pursuing these projects in an open format is that they will be constantly upgraded with new and interesting features.

Trend+: Open source aficionados need no introduction to the sundry community projects aimed at improving society. But, interestingly, governments are also now making a concerted effort to adopt open source technologies for better results. Quite recently, in November 2013, the Government of Ecuador started a project to 're-imagine Ecuador' based on open networks, peer production and communing. According to official reports, the 10-month project aims to remodel the roots of Ecuador's economy, setting off a transition into a society of free and open knowledge. The themes will include open education, open innovation and science, open design commons, distributed manufacturing, sustainable agriculture, open machining, legal and institutional frameworks to support open productive capacities, open technical infrastructures and systems for privacy, security, data ownership, and digital rights.

In a similar though smaller scale effort, the Commissionerate of Municipal Administration (CMA) and ThoughtWorks together conducted a Hackathon in Chennai, aimed at improving governance in the city. Several technologists and students worked together to design apps for

better urban and rural governance in Tamil Nadu. Some of the outcomes were, of course, based on open source platforms. The best project was TrashIt, an interesting Android app that enables crowdsourced garbage reporting. Since a long time, government agencies such as Tamil Nadu's ELCOT have adopted open source tools to implement better governance, and hundreds of government schools across the country run on open source software.

In September 2013, the Delhi police proposed the development of OSINT (Open Source Intelligent Solution) to extract and analyse information available on the Internet, to detect suspicious activity by criminals and terrorists, who the police said communicate mostly online to avoid detection. OSINT, according to news reports, will focus on gathering actionable intelligence, psychological analysis of the suspicious communication, profiling and indexing of suspects and information about them. The system will analyse social media like Facebook, Twitter, public forums and blogs, crunch tons of data, and support multiple languages. The Delhi police has invited global IT giants to help develop the system. 

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